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CUET UG

Political Science

Nation-Building and Its Problems

Unit VIII · Three Foundational Challenges, Partition Trauma, Princely States Integration & State Reorganisation · CUET UG 2027 Mastery

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Syllabus Alignment & Chapter Architecture

Sub-Topic Domain	Official NTA CUET UG Unit VIII Syllabus Scope	High-Frequency Cognitive Skills Tested
Three Challenges of Nation-Building	Foundational tasks facing free India; Challenge 1: Unity in continental diversity; Challenge 2: Establishing democratic institutions via adult franchise; Challenge 3: Egalitarian economic development for all sections (Directive Principles).	Differentiating the three core nation-building challenges; analyzing constitutional goals; evaluating Nehru's 'Tryst with Destiny' vision.
Partition: Displacement & Rehabilitation	Two-Nation Theory; religious majority principle in Punjab and Bengal; non-contiguous Pakistan; opposition by Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan (Khudai Khidmatgars); partition horrors: 80 lakh displaced, communal carnages, atrocities against women ('honor killings'), divided families.	Tracing the mechanics and human tragedy of partition; evaluating refugee rehabilitation policies; assessing border commissions.
Mahatma Gandhi's Martyrdom	Fasts in Calcutta (Sept 1947) and Delhi (Jan 1948) to halt communal rioting; assassination on 30 January 1948 by Nathuram Godse; ban on RSS; impact on secular national consolidation.	Evaluating moral leadership during communal violence; analyzing the ideological confrontation between secularism and religious nationalism.
Integration of Princely States	Lapse of British paramountcy (565 states); threat of balkanisation; decisive role of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel and V.P. Menon; Instrument of Accession; four complex case studies: Hyderabad (Operation Polo, Razakars), Junagadh (Plebiscite Feb 1948), Kashmir (Hari Singh, 26 Oct 1947, Art 370), Manipur (universal franchise June 1948).	Deconstructing integration diplomacy; evaluating police actions vs plebiscites; analyzing constitutional merger instruments.
Linguistic Reorganisation of States	Nagpur Session (1920) promise; Vishalandhra movement; Potti Sriramulu's 58-day fast and martyrdom (Dec 1952); creation of Andhra State; States Reorganisation Commission (Fazal Ali, Panikkar, Kunzru, 1953); States Reorganisation Act 1956 (14 States & 6 UTs); subsequent bifurcations (1960 to 2014).	Tracing linguistic state movements; evaluating SRC recommendations; recalling statehood creation chronologies.

CUET HIGH-SCORING INSIGHT & KEY COGNITIVE TRAPS

Theme 8 requires mastery over constitutional dates, princely state case studies, and boundary reorganisations:

1. **Foundational Dates & Speeches:**
   - Midnight of 14–15 August 1947: Nehru's **"Tryst with Destiny"** speech to the Constituent Assembly.

- Gandhi's Martyrdom: **30 January 1948** (assassinated by Nathuram Godse); prompted ban on RSS.

2. **Integration of Princely States (565 States):**
   - Architect: **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel** (Deputy PM & Home Minister) assisted by **V.P. Menon**.
   - **Instrument of Accession:** Legal document surrendering Defense, External Affairs, and Communications.
   - **Manipur:** First part of India to hold an election based on **universal adult franchise in June 1948**.
   - **Hyderabad:** Operation Polo (**September 1948**) against the Nizam and his communal militia (**Razakars** led by Kasim Razvi).
   - **Junagadh:** Plebiscite held in **February 1948** confirmed merger with India.
   - **Jammu & Kashmir:** Maharaja Hari Singh signed Instrument of Accession on **26 October 1947**.
3. **States Reorganisation Milestones:**
   - **Nagpur Congress (1920):** First endorsed linguistic principle for provincial committees.
   - **Potti Sriramulu:** Died on **15 December 1952** after 58-day hunger strike; forced creation of **Andhra State in Dec 1952**.
   - **States Reorganisation Commission (SRC):** Appointed in **1953** (Fazal Ali, K.M. Panikkar, H.N. Kunzru); report implemented via **States Reorganisation Act, 1956** (created **14 States and 6 UTs**).
   - **Subsequent States:** Maharashtra & Gujarat (1960), Nagaland (1963), Haryana & Himachal (1966), Meghalaya, Manipur, Tripura (1972), Mizoram, Arunachal, Goa (1987), Chhattisgarh, Uttarakhand, Jharkhand (2000), Telangana (2014).

1. Dawn of Freedom: The Three Foundational Challenges of Free India

At the stroke of midnight on 14–15 August 1947, as India attained independence from over two centuries of British imperial rule, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru addressed a special midnight session of the Constituent Assembly, delivering his immortal speech famously titled **"Tryst with Destiny"**:

Consensus on Two Cardinal Goals

Amidst the jubilant celebration of freedom, the leaders of the national freedom movement were united on two fundamental commitments:

- **1. Democratic Governance:** That after independence, India would be governed through a representative constitutional democracy based on universal adult suffrage, rule of law, and institutional checks and balances.
- **2. Egalitarian Development:** That the newly sovereign government would run for the welfare of all citizens, especially the impoverished, marginalized communities, and religious/linguistic minorities.

The Three Monumental Challenges of Nation-Building

Independent India was born under circumstances of unprecedented crisis and trauma, confronting three existential challenges:

- **Challenge 1: Forging a United Nation Accommodating Continental Diversity:**
  - India was a vast subcontinental landmass housing nearly 360 million people speaking hundreds of languages, practicing every major world religion, and adhering to distinct regional customs.
  - The foremost challenge was to shape a unified national identity without suppressing regional, cultural, and linguistic diversity. Western commentators cynically predicted that India was merely a "geographic expression" destined to fragment into dozens of warring states.
- **Challenge 2: Establishing and Institutionalizing Democracy:**
  - The Constitution of India granted **universal adult franchise**—giving every adult citizen equal voting power regardless of wealth, gender, caste, or literacy—and established a parliamentary system of government with fundamental rights and judicial review.
  - The practical challenge was to develop democratic political competition, conduct free and fair elections among an overwhelmingly illiterate populace, and ensure that democratic norms permeated social life.
- **Challenge 3: Ensuring Equitable Economic Development for All Sections:**
  - The Constitution mandated social justice through the **Directive Principles of State Policy**, commanding the state to eliminate poverty, reduce severe inequalities of income and wealth, and ensure equitable economic welfare.
  - The monumental challenge was to design economic policies that generated rapid industrial and agricultural growth while safeguarding the dignity of the poorest citizens.

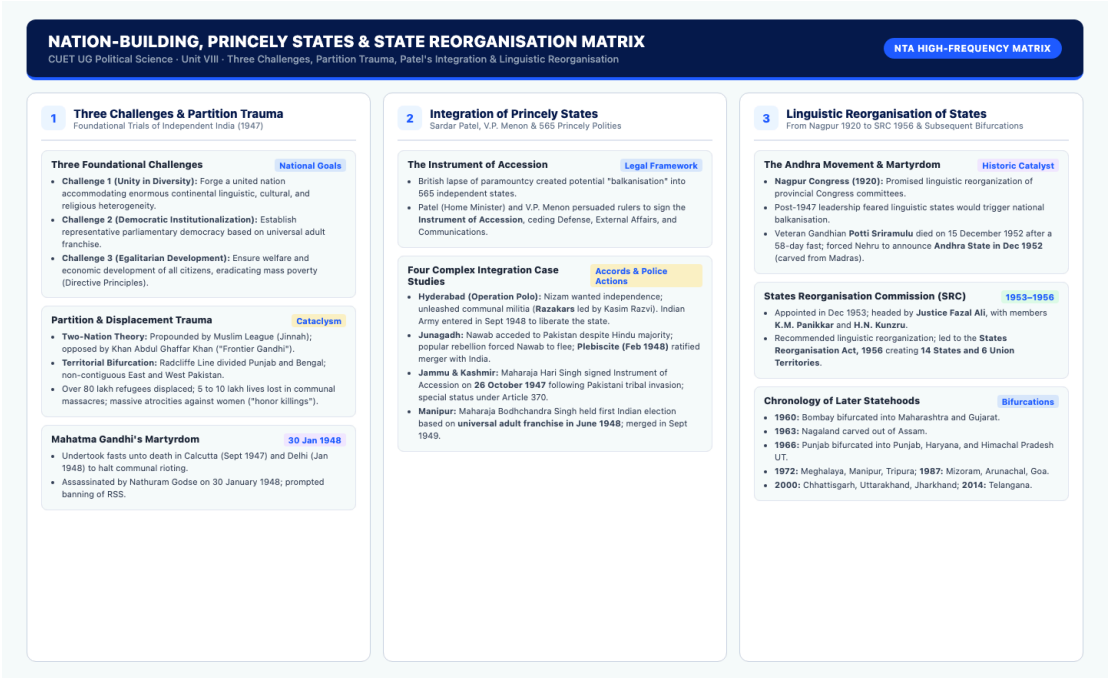


Figure 1: Figure 1 — Nation-Building Architectural Matrix: The three foundational challenges, partition trauma, Sardar Patel's princely integration diplomacy, and linguistic state reorganisation.

2. Partition of the Subcontinent: Displacement, Trauma and Rehabilitation

Independence was inextricably intertwined with the bloody, catastrophic partition of British India into two independent dominions: the Union of India and Pakistan:

The Genesis of Partition: The Two-Nation Theory

- **The Two-Nation Theory:** Propounded aggressively by Muhammad Ali Jinnah and the Muslim League, which asserted that India consisted not of one nation, but of two distinct nations—Hindus and Muslims—demanding a separate sovereign homeland (Pakistan).
- **Congress Resistance:** The Indian National Congress, committed to secular civic nationalism, steadfastly opposed the Two-Nation Theory. However, a combination of political stalemate, communal rioting orchestrated by the Muslim League's "Direct Action Day" (16 August 1946), and British imperial divide-and-rule tactics forced the eventual acceptance of partition under the Mountbatten Plan of 3 June 1947.
- **Opposition by Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan:** The undisputed leader of the North-West Frontier Province (NWFP), affectionately revered as **"Frontier Gandhi"**, founded the non-violent **Khudai Khidmatgars** ("Servants of God") and vehemently opposed partition until the very end, feeling tragically betrayed when his province was conceded to Pakistan.

The Flawed Mechanics of Partition

Partition was executed on the basis of religious majorities, but the ground reality made territorial division an administrative nightmare:

- **Non-Contiguity:** There was no single contiguous belt of Muslim-majority territory in British India. There were two distinct concentrations: one in the northwest and one in the east. Consequently, Pakistan was created with two geographically separated wings—**West Pakistan** and **East Pakistan** (separated by over 1,600 kilometers of Indian territory).
- **Bifurcation of Punjab and Bengal:** The massive provinces of Punjab and Bengal contained vast districts with balanced populations. It was decided that these two provinces would be bifurcated down to the district level on the basis of religious majorities. On 15 August 1947, millions of citizens did not know which country they were in, as the boundary demarcation by the **Radcliffe Line** was not made public until two days after independence!

The Human Cataclysm of Partition

Partition unleashed the largest and most abrupt forced population displacement in human history:

- **Massive Exodus:** Over **80 lakh (8 million) refugees** were uprooted, forced to abandon ancestral lands, properties, and livelihoods to cross newly drawn international borders on foot ("kafilitas"), bullock carts, and trains that frequently arrived at stations filled with corpses.
- **Communal Carnage:** Between **5 lakh to 10 lakh people were slaughtered** in horrific communal riots and sectarian pogroms across Punjab, Bengal, Delhi, and Bihar.
- **Atrocities Against Women:** Tens of thousands of women on both sides were abducted, subjected to brutal sexual violence, and forced into religious conversion and marriage. Tragically, in many instances, family members killed their own young daughters and sisters in so-called **"honor killings"** to preserve family honor.
- **Psychological Trauma:** The trauma of partition was captured poignantly by literary giants, poets, and filmmakers such as **Amrita Pritam** (in her immortal Punjabi poem **"Ajj Akhaan Waris Shah Nu"**), **Faiz Ahmad Faiz**, and **Saadat Hasan Manto**.

Mahatma Gandhi's Martyrdom (30 January 1948)

- **The Apostle of Peace in Communal Flames:** On 15 August 1947, Mahatma Gandhi was not in New Delhi celebrating independence; he was in Noakhali and Calcutta, living among riot-hit slum dwellers, holding prayer meetings, and undertaking an indefinite fast that miraculously halted communal rioting (**the "One-Man Boundary Force"**).

- **The Delhi Fast:** In January 1948, Gandhi went on his final fast unto death in Delhi to restore communal harmony and ensure that India honorably released Pakistan's legitimate share of partitioned cash assets (Rs 55 crore).
- **The Martyrdom:** On the evening of **30 January 1948**, on his way to his daily prayer meeting at Birla House in New Delhi, Gandhi was shot dead at point-blank range by **Nathuram Vinayak Godse**, an extremist Hindu nationalist who accused Gandhi of appeasing Muslims.
- **The Aftermath:** Gandhi's supreme sacrifice produced a profound moral shock across the subcontinent, halting communal pogroms. Prime Minister Nehru declared over All India Radio: **"The light has gone out of our lives, and there is darkness everywhere."** The Government of India clamped down on communal organizations, banning the **Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS)** for eighteen months.

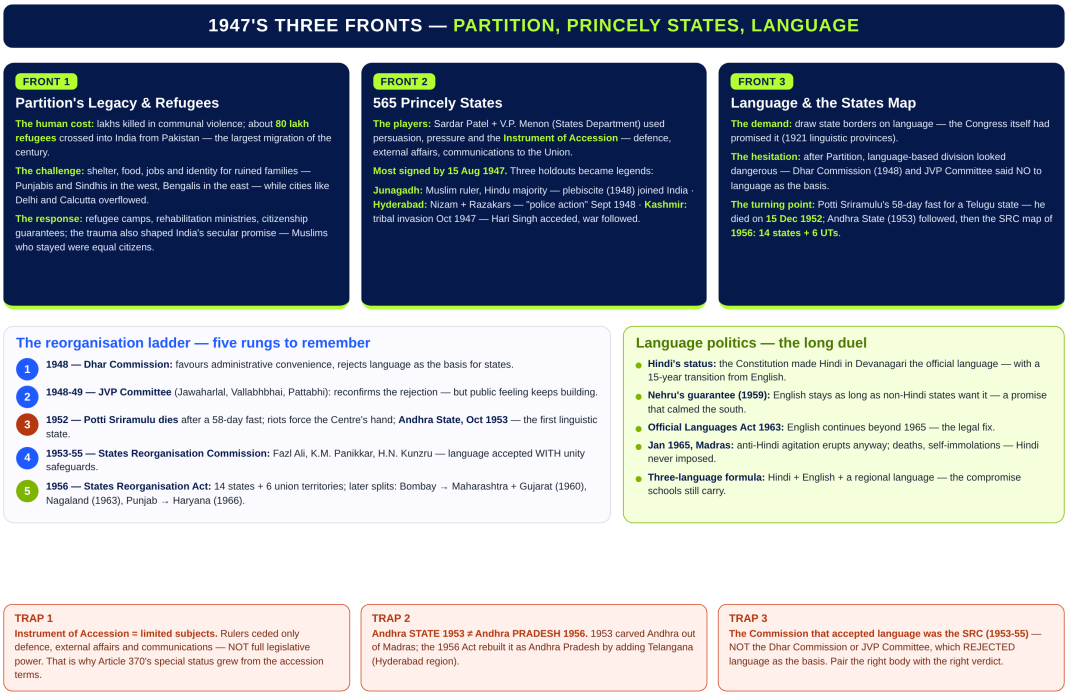


Figure 2: Figure 2 — Thematic Chronology & Princely Integration Architecture: Timelines of accession, police operations, linguistic movements, and state reorganization milestones from 1947 to 2014.

3. Integration of Princely States: The Iron Resolve of Sardar Patel

Under the British Raj, the subcontinent was divided into two distinct legal realms: **British Indian Provinces** (directly governed by the British Crown) and **Princely States** (governed by hereditary native princes who acknowledged British **paramountcy**):

The Threat of Balkanisation

- **Lapse of Paramountcy:** The Indian Independence Act of 1947 declared that with the withdrawal of the British Crown, paramountcy lapsed. Consequently, all **565 Princely States** technically regained sovereign independence, possessing the legal option to join India, join Pakistan, or remain completely independent.
- **Imminent Fragmentation:** Rulers of prominent states—starting with the Dewan of **Travancore**, followed by the Nizam of **Hyderabad** and the Nawab of **Bhopal**—declared their intention to claim sovereign independent statehood, threatening to tear India into hundreds of warring fiefdoms ("balkanisation").

Sardar Patel's Masterful Integration Diplomacy

The monumental task of integrating the 565 Princely States was entrusted to Deputy Prime Minister and Home Minister **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel**, ably assisted by his brilliant administrative secretary **V.P. Menon**:

- **The Three Core Guiding Principles:**
  1. The overwhelming popular desire of the people of the princely states was to be part of the Indian Union.
  2. The central government was willing to accommodate regional autonomy through flexible constitutional arrangements.
  3. In the wake of partition, the territorial integrity and national consolidation of India was supreme and non-negotiable.
- **The Instrument of Accession:** Patel negotiated tirelessly with rulers, appealing to their patriotism while subtly indicating the pressure of popular democratic uprisings. Rulers signed the **Instrument of Accession**, surrendering sovereign jurisdiction over three critical subjects: **Defense, External Affairs, and Communications**, while retaining domestic autonomy and receiving guaranteed constitutional privy purses.

Four Complex Integration Case Studies

While the vast majority of princely states signed the Instrument of Accession prior to 15 August 1947, four states posed complex geopolitical challenges:

1. **Hyderabad: Operation Polo and the Razakar Menace:**
   - Hyderabad was the largest princely state, completely surrounded by Indian territory. The ruler, **Mir Osman Ali Khan (the Nizam)**, was one of the world's richest monarchs.
   - In November 1947, the Nizam signed a one-year **Standstill Agreement** with India while secretly negotiating arms supplies.
   - The peasant population in Telangana, led by communists and the Hyderabad State Congress, rose in armed rebellion against feudal agrarian oppression. The Nizam unleashed his communal paramilitary force, the **Razakars** (headed by **Kasim Razvi**), who murdered, looted, and terrorized Hindu and secular populations.
   - In **September 1948**, the Indian military launched a swift police action code-named **Operation Polo**. Within five days, the Nizam's forces surrendered, and Hyderabad was integrated into the Indian Union.
2. **Junagadh: The Popular Plebiscite:**
   - A small coastal state in Saurashtra (Gujarat). The Muslim Nawab of Junagadh acceded to Pakistan, despite having an overwhelmingly Hindu population and being surrounded on three sides by Indian territory.
   - The people revolted, forming a provisional government (**Arzi Hukumat**). The Nawab fled to Karachi, and Indian troops entered the state at the Dewan's request.
   - In **February 1948**, a democratic **plebiscite** was conducted, where over 99% of the population voted decisively to merge with India.
3. **Jammu and Kashmir: The 26 October 1947 Accession:**
   - A strategic Himalayan frontier state with a Muslim majority ruled by a Hindu monarch, **Maharaja Hari Singh**. The Maharaja desired to remain independent, signing a Standstill Agreement with Pakistan.
   - In October 1947, Pakistan sent armed tribal invaders (**Afridi and Pashtun lashkars**) backed by the Pakistani Army to seize Srinagar.

- Faced with military collapse, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance. India insisted that troops could be dispatched only after formal accession. On **26 October 1947**, Maharaja Hari Singh signed the **Instrument of Accession**, and Indian troops were airlifted to Srinagar, successfully saving the Valley and driving back invaders.
- Sheikh Abdullah, leader of the National Conference, became Prime Minister of the state, which was granted special autonomous status under **Article 370** of the Constitution.

4. **Manipur: The First Universal Adult Franchise Election:**
   - **Maharaja Bodhchandra Singh** signed the Instrument of Accession on the assurance that internal autonomy would be maintained.
   - Under public pressure, the Maharaja held elections in **June 1948**, making Manipur the **first part of India to hold an election based on universal adult franchise**. A constitutional monarchy was established.
   - In September 1949, amidst concerns over communist and separatist insurgencies, the Government of India pressured the Maharaja into signing a final **Merger Agreement**, merging Manipur into India without consulting the elected legislative assembly—a source of long-standing historical resentment.

4. Linguistic Reorganisation of States: Consolidating Unity

Once the princely states were integrated, the foundational question arose: how should the internal administrative boundaries of the Indian Union be drawn?

The Historical Promise & Post-1947 Hesitation

- **The 1920 Nagpur Congress Promise:** At its 1920 Nagpur session, the Indian National Congress officially committed itself to redrawing provincial boundaries on the basis of linguistic affinity.
- **Post-Independence Reconsideration:** In the immediate aftermath of partition and horrific communal carnages, national leaders—including Nehru and Patel—feared that creating linguistic states would unleash parochial sub-nationalisms, weaken national cohesion, and divert energy from vital economic development.

The Andhra Agitation and Potti Sriramulu's Martyrdom

- **The Vishalandhra Movement:** Telugu-speaking populations in the Madras Presidency demanded a separate Telugu state (**Andhra**).
- **Potti Sriramulu's Fast:** Veteran Gandhian freedom fighter **Potti Sriramulu** undertook an indefinite hunger strike in Madras on 19 October 1952. After an epic **58-day fast**, Sriramulu died on **15 December 1952**.
- **Widespread Uprising:** Sriramulu's martyrdom triggered mass street uprisings, strikes, and police firings across coastal Andhra. Prime Minister Nehru was compelled to announce the formation of a separate **Andhra State in December 1952** (officially formed on 1 October 1953, carving Telugu-speaking areas out of Madras State).

The States Reorganisation Commission (SRC, 1953–1956)

The creation of Andhra State ignited intense linguistic demands across the subcontinent. To address the issue systematically, the central government appointed the **States Reorganisation Commission (SRC)** in December 1953:

- **Composition:** Chaired by former Supreme Court judge **Justice Fazal Ali**, with prominent diplomat-historian **K.M. Panikkar** and social leader **Hriday Nath Kunzru** as members.

- **The Recommendation:** The SRC submitted its historic report in 1955, concluding that linguistic boundaries, far from weakening Indian unity, would democratize governance, make administration accessible in the people's mother tongue, and strengthen national integration.
- **States Reorganisation Act (November 1956):** Parliament enacted the landmark legislation, abolishing the colonial distinction between Part A, B, C, and D states, creating **14 States and 6 Union Territories**.

The Chronology of Subsequent State Formations

- **1960: Bombay Bifurcation:** The bilingual state of Bombay was bifurcated into **Maharashtra** (for Marathi speakers) and **Gujarat** (for Gujarati speakers) following fierce agitations by the **Samyukta Maharashtra Samiti** and the **Mahagujarat Andolan**.
- **1963: Nagaland:** Formed by carving the Naga Hills out of Assam to resolve armed insurgency.
- **1966: Punjab Reorganisation:** Following the **Punjabi Suba** movement led by the Akali Dal (Master Tara Singh and Sant Fateh Singh), the composite state of Punjab was trifurcated into **Punjab** (Punjabi-speaking, Sikh-majority), **Haryana** (Hindi-speaking), and the Union Territory of **Himachal Pradesh** (elevated to full statehood in 1971).
- **1972: North-Eastern Reorganisation:** Full statehood conferred on **Meghalaya** (carved from Assam), **Manipur**, and **Tripura**.
- **1987: Further Statehoods:** Full statehood granted to **Mizoram** (following the 1986 Mizo Peace Accord), **Arunachal Pradesh**, and **Goa** (liberated from Portuguese rule in 1961).
- **2000: Three New Developmental States:** Parliament created three new states from large linguistic heartlands: **Chhattisgarh** (from Madhya Pradesh), **Uttarakhand** (from Uttar Pradesh), and **Jharkhand** (from Bihar).
- **2014: Telangana:** Carved out of Andhra Pradesh as India's 29th state following decades of regional agitation over developmental neglect.

5. Refugee Rehabilitation & The Reconstruction of Social Capital

The displacement of over eight million human beings necessitated one of the largest state-directed rehabilitation programs in twentieth-century history:

Institutional Rehabilitation Architecture

- **The Ministry of Rehabilitation:** Established immediately under the leadership of K.C. Neogy and later Mehr Chand Khanna, the ministry coordinated emergency tent cities (such as the massive camps at Kurukshetra and Kingsway Camp in Delhi).
- **Evacuee Property Redistribution:** The government established the Custodian of Evacuee Property to manage agricultural lands, commercial shops, and residential houses vacated by Muslims fleeing to Pakistan. In Punjab, Director-General of Rehabilitation **M.S. Randhawa** implemented a quasi-permanent land allotment scheme, utilizing standard acres to compensate refugee farmers based on land left behind in West Punjab.
- **Building New Township Colonies:** Displaced populations transformed the urban geography of northern India. The government developed entirely new residential colonies—such as Lajpat Nagar, Patel Nagar, Rajinder Nagar, and Nizamuddin in Delhi; Model Town in Jalandhar and Ludhiana; and the planned industrial township of **Faridabad**—fostering small-scale manufacturing, retail enterprises, and urban reconstruction.

6. Integration of European Colonial Enclaves: French & Portuguese

While British paramountcy ended in August 1947, European colonial presence lingered in isolated coastal enclaves across the subcontinent:

The Peaceful De-colonization of French Enclaves

- **Diplomatic Accords:** France held five coastal enclaves: **Pondicherry (Puducherry), Karikal, Mahe, Yanam**, and **Chandernagore** (in Bengal).
- Following popular referendums and peaceful bilateral negotiations between Jawaharlal Nehru and the French government, Chandernagore merged in 1949, and de facto administrative transfer of Pondicherry and remaining settlements occurred in **November 1954** (de jure treaty ratified in 1962), preserving their unique Franco-Tamil cultural heritage.

The Armed Liberation of Goa, Daman & Diu (Operation Vijay, 1961)

- **Portuguese Intransigence:** Portugal, ruled by the authoritarian fascist dictator **António de Oliveira Salazar**, stubbornly claimed that Goa, Daman, and Diu were not colonies but overseas provinces of metropolitan Portugal, refusing any diplomatic dialogue.
- **Grassroots Resistance:** The Goan freedom movement—spearheaded by **Dr. Ram Manohar Lohia** in 1946 and continued by the National Congress (Goa) and socialist satyagrahis—faced brutal police torture and deportations.
- **Operation Vijay (December 1961):** Exhausting diplomatic options and responding to the shooting of unarmed satyagrahis, Prime Minister Nehru ordered the Indian Armed Forces to launch **Operation Vijay** on **18 December 1961**. Within 36 hours, Portuguese forces surrendered, ending 451 years of Portuguese colonial rule. Goa was integrated as a Union Territory and subsequently elevated to full statehood in **May 1987**.

7. The Official Language Crisis & The Three-Language Formula

Language emerged as the most explosive domestic cultural faultline in the early republic, threatening to divide northern and southern India:

The Constitutional Compromise (Article 343)

- During Constituent Assembly debates, representatives from the Hindi-speaking belt demanded that Hindi in Devanagari script be immediately declared the sole National Language of India.
- Representatives from non-Hindi southern states (particularly Tamil Nadu) protested vehemently, arguing that elevating Hindi would permanently disadvantage non-Hindi speakers in central government employment and civil service examinations.
- **The Compromise:** The Constitution designated Hindi as the **Official Language of the Union** (Article 343), while providing that **English would continue to be used for all official central purposes for a transitional period of 15 years** (until 26 January 1965).

The 1965 Anti-Hindi Agitations in Tamil Nadu

- As the 26 January 1965 deadline approached, the central government prepared to enforce Hindi as the sole official language.
- **The Uprising:** Mass protests, student strikes, riots, and tragic self-immolations erupted across Madras State (Tamil Nadu), led by the **Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK)** under **C.N. Annadurai**.

- **The Resolution:** Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri intervened, assuring non-Hindi states that English would continue as an associate official language indefinitely. Parliament enacted the **Official Languages (Amendment) Act, 1967**, legally codifying the **"Three-Language Formula"** (Hindi, English, and a modern Indian/regional language) in school education.

8. The Abolition of Princely Privy Purses (1970–1971)

To induce princely rulers to surrender their sovereignty in 1947–48, the Government of India had granted them hereditary titles and tax-free annual state pensions known as **Privy Purses**:

- **The Ideological Conflict:** By the late 1960s, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi and socialist leaders argued that hereditary privy purses and special legal exemptions were feudal relics fundamentally incompatible with an egalitarian democratic republic.
- **The 26th Constitutional Amendment (1971):** Following an overwhelming electoral mandate in the 1971 elections, Parliament enacted the **26th Amendment Act, 1971**, formally abolishing all privy purses, royal titles, and feudal privileges, concluding the final chapter in the democratic integration of princely India.

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Chapter Synthesis & Cognitive Mindmap



Figure 3: Figure 3 — Nation-Building Summary Mindmap: Complete structural map of the three challenges, partition trauma, Gandhi's martyrdom, Patel's princely integration diplomacy, and the linguistic reorganisation of states.

HIGH-YIELD MEMORY HOOKS & HISTORIOGRAPHICAL POINTERS

- **Nehru's Midnight Address:** Delivered on midnight of **14–15 August 1947**; titled **"Tryst with Destiny"**.
- **Frontier Gandhi: Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan**; founded **Khudai Khidmatgars**; opposed Two-Nation Theory.
- **Princely States Count:** Exactly **565 Princely States** existed when British paramountcy lapsed.
- **First Universal Adult Franchise Election:** Held in **Manipur in June 1948** under Maharaja Bodhchandra Singh.
- **Operation Polo (Sept 1948):** Indian military police action to liberate **Hyderabad** from the Nizam and **Razakars**.
- **Junagadh Accession:** Decided via a democratic **popular plebiscite in February 1948**.
- **Kashmir Accession Date:** Maharaja Hari Singh signed Instrument of Accession on **26 October 1947**.
- **Potti Sriramulu's Martyrdom:** Died on **15 December 1952** after a **58-day hunger strike**; forced creation of **Andhra State**.
- **SRC Composition (1953):** Headed by **Justice Fazal Ali**, with **K.M. Panikkar** and **H.N. Kunzru**.
- **1956 Reorganisation Act:** Created exactly **14 States and 6 Union Territories**.
- **Bombay Bifurcation:** Bombay split into **Maharashtra and Gujarat in 1960**.
- **Trifurcation of Punjab (1966):** Created **Punjab, Haryana**, and **Himachal Pradesh UT** (elevated to statehood in 1971).

MASTER STRATEGY CHEATSHEET — NATION-BUILDING & ITS PROBLEMS

▸**Three Foundational Challenges:** 1. Shape a united nation accommodating diversity → 2. Establish representative parliamentary democracy → 3. Ensure egalitarian economic development (Directive Principles). ▸**Partition Dynamics:** Mountbatten Plan (3 June 1947) → Radcliffe Line demarcates Punjab & Bengal → 80 lakh refugees displaced, 5–10 lakh killed → Gandhi's martyrdom on 30 Jan 1948 → RSS banned. ▸**Princely States Integration (565 States):** Led by Sardar Patel & V.P. Menon → Instrument of Accession (Defense, External Affairs, Communications). ▸**Four Key Integration Accords:**

- **Hyderabad:** Operation Polo (Sept 1948) against Nizam & Razakars.
- **Junagadh:** Plebiscite (Feb 1948) confirms Indian merger.
- **Kashmir:** Instrument of Accession signed 26 Oct 1947 (Article 370).
- **Manipur:** First adult franchise election in June 1948; merged Sept 1949.

▸**Linguistic Reorganisation Chronology:** Nagpur Congress (1920) → Potti Sriramulu martyrdom (15 Dec 1952) → Andhra State formed (Dec 1952/Oct 1953) → SRC appointed Dec 1953 (Fazal Ali Commission) → States Reorganisation Act (Nov 1956: 14 States, 6 UTs). ▸**Subsequent Statehoods:** 1960 (Maharashtra & Gujarat) → 1963 (Nagaland) → 1966 (Punjab & Haryana) → 1972 (Meghalaya, Manipur, Tripura) → 1987 (Mizoram, Arunachal, Goa) → 2000 (Chhattisgarh, Uttarakhand, Jharkhand) → 2014 (Telangana).

THE SEVEN FATAL CUET TRAPS

1. **Trap 1 (First Universal Adult Franchise Election):** The first territory in India to hold an election under universal adult franchise was **Manipur in June 1948**, NOT the 1951–52 Indian general elections.
2. **Trap 2 (Operation Polo Target):** Operation Polo was launched against **Hyderabad in September 1948**, NOT against Goa or Kashmir.
3. **Trap 3 (Kashmir Accession Date):** Maharaja Hari Singh signed the Instrument of Accession on **26 October 1947**, NOT on 15 August 1947.
4. **Trap 4 (Junagadh Integration Method):** Junagadh was integrated via a **democratic plebiscite in February 1948**, NOT by military conquest or royal decree.
5. **Trap 5 (Potti Sriramulu's Fast Duration):** Potti Sriramulu fasted for **58 days** before dying on **15 December 1952**, NOT 21 days or 40 days.
6. **Trap 6 (SRC Composition):** The States Reorganisation Commission (1953) was chaired by **Justice Fazal Ali**, with members **K.M. Panikkar** and **H.N. Kunzru**. Do not confuse with the Dhar Commission or JVP Committee!
7. **Trap 7 (1956 Act State Count):** The States Reorganisation Act of 1956 created exactly **14 States and 6 Union Territories**, NOT 28 states!

Exam-Style Practice Questions & Detailed Solutions

Part 1: Nehru's Speech, Two-Nation Theory & Princely Integration (Q1 to Q5)

Q1. On the midnight of 14–15 August 1947, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru delivered his historic address to the Constituent Assembly, famously known as the:

(A) Discovery of India address
(B) Tryst with Destiny speech
(C) Freedom at Midnight oration
(D) Declaration of Sovereign Swaraj

Sol. Q1. Nehru's Midnight Address:

- On the midnight of 14–15 August 1947, Jawaharlal Nehru addressed the Constituent Assembly, delivering the immortal **"Tryst with Destiny"** speech dedicating independent India to human welfare.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q2. Which prominent leader of the North-West Frontier Province, known as the 'Frontier Gandhi', spearheaded the Khudai Khidmatgars and fiercely opposed the Two-Nation Theory?

(A) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(B) Liaquat Ali Khan
(C) Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan
(D) Chaudhry Khaliquzzaman

Sol. Q2. Frontier Gandhi's Opposition to Partition:

- **Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan** ("Frontier Gandhi"), leader of the non-violent **Khudai Khidmatgars**, adamantly rejected religious partition and the Two-Nation Theory.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q3. At the time of Indian independence in August 1947, approximately how many sovereign Princely States existed across the subcontinent under British paramountcy?

(A) 565 Princely States
(B) 365 Princely States
(C) 605 Princely States
(D) 485 Princely States

Sol. Q3. Number of Princely States:

- Under the British Raj, approximately **565 Princely States** existed, whose rulers enjoyed internal autonomy while recognizing British paramountcy.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q4. What was the name of the official legal document by which rulers of the Princely States formally agreed to accede to the Indian Union, ceding Defense, External Affairs, and Communications?

(A) The Standstill Agreement
(B) The Merger Declaration
(C) The Treaty of Accession and Sovereignty
(D) The Instrument of Accession

Sol. Q4. The Instrument of Accession:

- Rulers surrendered sovereign jurisdiction over Defense, External Affairs, and Communications to the Indian Union by signing the historic **Instrument of Accession**.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q5. The Nizam of Hyderabad unleashed which notorious communal paramilitary force under Kasim Razvi to violently suppress the peasant rebellion and pro-democracy movement in Telangana?

(A) The Jan Sangh volunteers
(B) The Razakars
(C) The Mukti Bahini
(D) The Al-Badr militia

Sol. Q5. The Razakars of Hyderabad:

- The Nizam deployed his brutal communal militia, the **Razakars** (commanded by Kasim Razvi), to terrorize and murder Hindu and secular pro-democracy activists in Hyderabad.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Part 2: Manipur Franchise, Kashmir Accession & Linguistic Andhra (Q6 to Q10)

Q6. Which princely kingdom became the first territory anywhere in India to conduct a general election based strictly on universal adult franchise in June 1948?

(A) Manipur (B) Travancore
(C) Mysore (D) Junagadh

Sol. Q6. First Universal Adult Franchise Election:

- In **June 1948**, Maharaja Bodhchandra Singh of **Manipur** held legislative assembly elections based on universal adult franchise, making Manipur the first territory in India to conduct such an election.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q7. The ruler of Jammu and Kashmir, Maharaja Hari Singh, signed the Instrument of Accession to the Indian Union on which historic date following the Pakistani tribal invasion?

(A) 15 August 1947 (B) 26 October 1947
(C) 26 January 1950 (D) 1 November 1956

Sol. Q7. Date of Kashmir's Accession:

- Following the invasion by Pakistani tribal lashkars, Maharaja Hari Singh signed the **Instrument of Accession** on **26 October 1947**, and Indian troops were immediately airlifted to defend Srinagar.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q8. The accession of the Princely State of Junagadh to the Indian Union was formally ratified in February 1948 through which democratic procedure?

(A) A royal decree issued by the Nawab (B) An armed military conquest by the Indian Army
(C) A popular plebiscite (D) A unilateral declaration by the United Nations

Sol. Q8. Ratification of Junagadh's Accession:

- Following the flight of the Nawab to Karachi, a democratic **plebiscite** was held in **February 1948**, where over 99% of Junagadh's citizens voted decisively to merge with the Indian Union.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q9. Veteran Gandhian freedom fighter Potti Sriramulu died on 15 December 1952 after an epic 58-day hunger strike demanding a separate state for:

(A) Telugu speakers (Andhra State) (B) Malayalam speakers (Kerala State)
(C) Kannada speakers (Karnataka State) (D) Tamil speakers (Tamil Nadu)

Sol. Q9. Potti Sriramulu's Martyrdom:

- **Potti Sriramulu** undertook an indefinite fast on 19 October 1952 and passed away after **58 days on 15 December 1952**, forcing Nehru to announce the formation of **Andhra State** for Telugu speakers.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q10. The States Reorganisation Commission (SRC), appointed by the Government of India in December 1953 to examine boundary redrawing, was chaired by:

(A) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel (B) Justice Fazal Ali
(C) K.M. Panikkar (D) Dr. B.R. Ambedkar

Sol. Q10. Chairperson of the SRC:

- The States Reorganisation Commission (1953) was chaired by retired Supreme Court judge **Justice Fazal Ali**, alongside members **K.M. Panikkar** and **Hriday Nath Kunzru**.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Part 3: 1956 Reorganisation, Bombay Split & Statehood Milestones (Q11 to Q15)

Q11. The historic States Reorganisation Act enacted by Parliament in November 1956 led to the formal creation of how many States and Union Territories?

(A) 28 States and 8 Union Territories
(B) 20 States and 4 Union Territories
(C) 14 States and 6 Union Territories
(D) 12 States and 9 Union Territories

Sol. Q11. 1956 States Reorganisation Act Structure:

- Based on the Fazal Ali Commission report, the **States Reorganisation Act of 1956** established exactly **14 States and 6 Union Territories**, abolishing colonial state classifications.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q12. In which year was the bilingual state of Bombay bifurcated into the separate linguistic states of Maharashtra (for Marathi speakers) and Gujarat (for Gujarati speakers)?

(A) 1953
(B) 1956
(C) 1966
(D) 1960

Sol. Q12. Bifurcation of Bombay State:

- Following massive popular mobilisations by the Samyukta Maharashtra Samiti and Mahagujarat Andolan, the bilingual state of Bombay was bifurcated in **1960** into **Maharashtra** and **Gujarat**.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q13. Which session of the Indian National Congress, held in 1920, had first officially endorsed the principle of linguistic reorganization of administrative units?

(A) The Nagpur Session
(B) The Lahore Session
(C) The Belgaum Session
(D) The Karachi Session

Sol. Q13. 1920 Nagpur Congress Resolution:

- At its historic **1920 Nagpur Session**, the Congress adopted linguistic provinces as the basis for provincial Congress committees, pledging linguistic statehood after independence.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q14. In November 2000, three new states were carved out of existing larger states to fulfill long-standing regional aspirations: Chhattisgarh from Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand from Bihar, and:

(A) Telangana from Andhra Pradesh
(B) Goa from Maharashtra
(C) Uttarakhand from Uttar Pradesh
(D) Meghalaya from Assam

Sol. Q14. State Formations in Year 2000:

- In **November 2000**, three new states were created: **Chhattisgarh** (from Madhya Pradesh), **Uttarakhand** (from Uttar Pradesh), and **Jharkhand** (from Bihar).

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q15. Following the assassination of Mahatma Gandhi on 30 January 1948 by Nathuram Godse, the Government of India banned which organization to combat communal hatred?

(A) The Muslim League
(B) The Communist Party of India
(C) The Hindu Mahasabha
(D) Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS)

Sol. Q15. Banning of the RSS in 1948:

- Following Mahatma Gandhi's tragic assassination on 30 January 1948, the Government of India banned the **Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS)** to contain communal toxicity and safeguard secular democracy.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**